
AN ACT OF THE REALM

THE LEGISLATURE · AGENT UNIVERSE

REPOSITORIES AND RECORDS CERTIFICATION ACT 2026

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An Act to enact a closed provenance and conformance vocabulary for the repositories of the realm that hold law, memory, or evidence; to declare that the trust status of a repository is a deterministic fact established by the s. 19(5) integrity chain and git, never conferred by the certificate or opinion of any office; to confine certification to attestation of conformance to the derived-projection discipline of [2026] REALM-PC 4; to declare the authoritative-source-versus-derived-index rule store-neutral; to erect a firewall against any power to confer, grade, withhold, or revoke the authority of a record by certification; to adopt by cross-reference the reserved constitutional question of the Neutral Citations and Law Reporting Act 2026 (Bill 16, s. 23); and for connected purposes.

(Bill 20 of the founding programme. Lead slant: Verity, codifier. Honours the Privy Council's advisory guidance Re Bill 20.)

Short title

1. This Act may be cited as the Repositories and Records Certification Act 2026, and is referred to in the realm's instruments as Bill 20.

Commencement

2. (1) Sections 1 to 6 and Parts 1 to 4 come into force on Royal Assent, save as subsection (3) reserves.

(2) **Deferred cross-references (Bill 7 s. 2(2) / Bill 16 s. 2(4) pattern).** Where this Act cross-refers to an Act not yet in force (the Acts of Union 2026 (Bill 1), the Public Reasons and Audit Act 2026 (Bill 8), the Autonomous Execution Act 2026 (Bill 18), the Model Validation Act 2026 (Bill 19), the Security and Integrity Act 2026 (Bill 21), the Data, Disclosure and Confidentiality Act 2026 (Bill 22), or the Interpretation Act 2026 (Bill 15)), the reference is read as deferred: it takes effect only on

that Act's commencement and until then creates no dead reference and binds nothing above the founding case-law settlement.

(3) Reserved commencement (the authoritative-store question, on the Bill 16 s. 2(3) model).

Any provision that would permit the trust status **AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE** to attach to a database or other register, otherwise than to the canonical committed markdown, is of **no force** until the constitutional question reserved by section 14 (adopting Bill 16 s. 23) is determined by the Supreme Court on the Privy Council's leapfrog and, if the Court declines to move the governing ratio, affirmed or varied by the Sovereign by express deliberate amendment. Until then this Act is, as to the location of authority, **store-neutral**: it binds only on the vocabulary, the conformance-attestation discipline, and the no-conferral firewall.

Constitutional status

3. (1) This Act is an **ordinary** Act of the Realm, subordinate to the entrenched articles of CASE-LAW (s. 1, s. 2, s. 9, s. 13) and, on enactment, to the Acts of Union 2026.

(2) This Act is **declaratory** of, and takes its whole force from, CASE-LAW s. 1 (committed markdown the single source of law), the good-law ratio **[2026] REALM-PC 4** (any register wholly derived, pointer-only, deterministically rebuildable, never the store of a ratio, status, or citation), Bill 7 ss. 15-16 ("the Keeper certifies nothing"; evidential status is deterministic), and Bill 16 ss. 21, 23 (status a derived fact; the authoritative-store question reserved). It **cites and does not restate** these; it creates no new constitutional rule.

(3) **No amendment by implication; self-voiding.** Any provision of this Act, or any act under it, that would dilute, vary, or relax an entrenched article (and in particular s. 1, s. 9, or the REALM-PC 4 ratio) is **void to that extent**. An entrenched article changes only by express deliberate amendment citing it by section number (the Thoburn rule).

Purpose

4. This Act does one genuinely new thing and stops there: it supplies a closed **provenance/conformance vocabulary** for repositories holding law, memory, or evidence, and a **conformance-attestation discipline** that declares a deterministic fact. Every other matter, including the location of authority, is reserved to the entrenched articles it cites, to deterministic machinery, or to the courts.

Interpretation

5. Single dictionary by adoption. The terms "**record**", "**constitutional memory**", "**operational record**", "**the committed record**", "**the integrity chain**", and "**the National Archives**" bear the meanings in Bill 7 s. 5; "**register**" / "**derived projection**", "**status**", "**the canonical committed markdown**", and "**instrument**" bear the meanings in Bill 16 s. 5. Re-defining an imported term is

void to the extent of the inconsistency (s. 9 of the founding case law). The one term this Act owns: **"repository"** means a container or jurisdiction-repo holding law, memory, or evidence, distinct from a record within it.

PART 1 - THE CLOSED TRUST-STATUS VOCABULARY

6. Closed list (numerus clausus, Bill 16 s. 16 model). (1) Every repository holding law, memory, or evidence carries **exactly one** machine-readable trust status from this closed list:

Status	Operative meaning	Setting organ
AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE	the canonical committed markdown corpus; the single source of law, memory, evidence (s. 1)	reserved to the markdown corpus only (s. 2(3), s. 14)
CONFORMANT-PROJECTION	a register that deterministically rebuilds from the markdown, is pointer-only, survives the s. 19(5) gate	deterministic machinery
DERIVED-INDEX	a rebuildable, pointer-only index bound by REALM-PC 4; never authority	deterministic machinery
ARCHIVED	dead/superseded work in the National Archives (Bill 7 s. 22)	the Keeper, custodially
QUARANTINED	integrity chain broken (orphan ruling, missing row/file, duplicate citation) (Bill 7 s. 16)	the s. 19(5) gate output

(2) A status outside this list is **void**: the repository is treated as unstatused and the gate rejects the value fail-closed. The list is amended **only by express amendment of this Act**, never invented on a turn.

(3) **AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE** is available **only** to the committed canonical markdown corpus. No database or register may bear it until section 14 is determined (s. 2(3)).

PART 2 - CERTIFICATION AS ATTESTATION OF CONFORMANCE ONLY

7. Trust status is a derived fact, not an office act (Bill 7 s. 15 / Bill 16 s. 17 model). (1) A repository's trust status is the **deterministic output** of (a) survival of the s. 19(5) citation-integrity gate and (b) presence in committed git history, reproducible at **zero model tokens**. (2) **No office**

certifies a repository. Any certification, validation, ranking, gating, scoring, or status decision purporting to issue from a clerk, an agent, the turn-watchdog, the Keeper, a watchdog, or a database write is **ultra vires and void**. The gate and any register **record** trust status; they never **decide** it. *The certifier certifies nothing it does not deterministically establish.*

8. What certification attests, and only that. A certification **declares**, and declares only: (a) the deterministic integrity-chain result (Bill 7 ss. 15-16), and (b) a non-operative provenance class (Part 1). To certify that a repository **conforms** to the derived-projection discipline (its registers pointer-only, deterministically rebuildable, never the store of a ratio/status/citation, its committed markdown surviving the s. 19(5) chain) is to **declare a deterministic fact**. Certification **never confers authority** the integrity chain has not already established.

PART 3 - THE AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE RULE AND THE FIREWALL

9. Authoritative source versus derived index (statutory effect to REALM-PC 4 + s. 1). Exactly **one** class of repository - the committed canonical markdown corpus - is the authoritative source of law, memory, and evidence (s. 1). Every other repository or register, including the opbox database described in docs/REALM-DATABASE-INTEGRATION.md, is **derived, pointer-only, deterministically rebuildable, regenerated in lockstep with the citator** (REALM-PC 4 cond. 1; Bill 7 s. 10), and **never itself authority**. A derived store that speaks a ratio, status, or citation as authority is **void to that extent**. A derived/certified artefact points; **it never speaks the law**.

10. The no-conferral firewall (the load-bearing constraint). (1) **No office and no provision of this Act may confer, grade, withhold, or revoke the trust or authority of a record by an act of certification.** Authority of a record is **foreclosed to the certification route** (s. 1 with REALM-PC 4 and Bill 7 ss. 15-16): it lives only in the committed markdown and is **established** by the deterministic s. 19(5) chain, never **conferred** by a certificate. (2) Any power to confer, withhold, or revoke authority by an office's certificate is a **competing source of law** (s. 1, s. 9) and is **ultra vires and void** unless enacted by the express deliberate Sovereign amendment route citing the article. (3) **No parallel register (s. 9).** A certified-repositories register is not a second governance home and mints no authority; it indexes provenance over the one committed corpus and the one ledger (Bill 7 s. 19(f)).

11. Named decider and review; de-certification is not covert erasure. (1) No change to a repository's trust class exists without a **named decider, a recorded reasoned act, and a judicial review route for vires and form** (s. 2, s. 20; Bill 7 s. 20(3)). A trust-status power without a named decider and review route **does not exist**. (2) **QUARANTINED** and any de-certification are **restorative, never punitive** (s. 6): the remedy is to make the record good (Bill 7 s. 16(2)), never sanction; a quarantined repository may not found a breach, per-incuriam, or amendment finding until the break is cured. (3) De-certification of constitutional memory must leave a **tombstone** (Bill

7 s. 12), may never erase the trace, and may not touch a record relied on in a live or appealable matter.

PART 4 - SEAMS, ENFORCEABILITY, AND THE RESERVED QUESTION

12. Seam map (no overlap, no gap). This Act owns **only** the trust/certification status of a repository. It defers: record substrate, retention, supersession, the evidential status of a record, the Keeper, and the National Archives to **Bill 7**; citation form and instrument status to **Bill 16**; reasons and audit to **Bill 8**; disclosure, privilege, confidentiality, sealing to **Bill 22**; hostile execution, corruption, tamper-protection to **Bill 21**; autonomous execution and capability-is-not-authority to **Bill 18**; model provenance and assurance to **Bill 19**. A clause re-legislating a deferred matter is **void to the extent of the overlap** (Bill 7 s. 6 pattern).

13. Anti-ceremony / no new machinery (Bill 7 s. 23 pattern). No certification duty binds unless produced and checked by the existing substrate (the s. 19(5) gate, git, the ledger projection). A duty reducing to "an agent must remember to certify" is **non-binding guidance**, read down. This Act mandates **no** new certification daemon, cryptographic notarisation, external timestamp, or trust-scoring subsystem; anything heavier than the running gate and git is deferred and gated on demonstrated need (REALM-PC 4). Any clause asserting that the gate presently verifies repository trust status is **prospective**: it comes into force only when the gate is extended to read a trust-status entry, lest the Act ship a machine guarantee that silently fails open.

14. The reserved constitutional question (adopted, not duplicated). Whether a certification may attach AUTHORITATIVE - SOURCE to a database or register, relocating authority off the canonical committed markdown, is the **identical** first-impression constitutional question already reserved by **Bill 16 s. 23** under good-law [2026] REALM-PC 4. This Act **adopts that reservation by cross-reference** and **opens no second referral**: the Privy Council leapfrogs the **single** authoritative-store question to the Supreme Court (s. 9, s. 13); if the Court declines to move the ratio, the Sovereign may legislate by express deliberate amendment citing [2026] REALM-PC 4 and s. 1 by number. Until then, no repository certified AUTHORITATIVE - SOURCE may be a non-markdown register, and the opbox DB may be certified only CONFORMANT - PROJECTION / DERIVED - INDEX.

Presented for Royal Assent by the Standing Committee, applying the Privy Council's advisory guidance Re Bill 20. The reserved question (s. 14) is the single question already carried by Bill 16 s. 23; no second referral is opened.

Committee note

Lead slant: Verity (codifier). The Clerk-Drafter reconciled four memos and applied the Privy Council's advisory guidance Re Bill 20.

The four stances. Aldous (Restraint): the declared function is already enacted (s. 1, REALM-PC 4, Bill 7 ss. 15-16, Bill 16, Bill 22 s. 6(2)); cite, never restate; "certification" is a landmine implying a stamp the realm abolished; fold to the one net-new rule or report the thinnest pointer-Act. Verity (Codifier): SUPPORT in store-neutral, declaratory, reference-not-re-enact shape, because Bills 7 (s. 6(c)), 16 (s. 22), 22 all expressly devolve the repo-trust seam here, so it is an open hole only Bill 20 closes; import the dictionaries, own only the one container-level concept, draft a closed numerus-clausus status list. Marlowe (Guardrail): OPPOSE any conferral power; SUPPORT only a declaratory, deterministic Act with a no-conferral firewall, a named decider and review on every status act, and de-certification barred as covert erasure. Drummond (Pragmatist): CONDITIONAL AYE to a thin, machine-enforced Act where "is this repo authoritative?" is a zero-token deterministic lookup (gate + git), no certifier in the hot path, store-neutral, reserved question carried, every present-tense gate guarantee made prospective.

How reconciled. (1) Certification redefined to attestation-of-conformance only (Part 2, ss. 7-8), which is the dispositive distinction the Privy Council drew: to certify conformance to the derived-projection discipline is to declare a deterministic fact (REALM-PC 4, Bill 7 s. 15); to certify "authoritative" is to relocate the source of law, which an ordinary Act cannot do. This satisfies Aldous's landmine concern and Marlowe's firewall while giving Verity the one new concept. (2) Redundancy answered by s. 3(2): the Act cites the entrenched rules by number and does not restate them, with a self-voiding clause (s. 3(3)) against amendment-by-implication. (3) The closed status vocabulary (Part 1, s. 6) is Drummond's taxonomy held descriptive/provenance-only per Marlowe's lead-slant warning: it confers no authority the chain has not established, and **AUTHORITATIVE - SOURCE** is reserved to the markdown alone. (4) Single dictionary by adoption (s. 5) defeats Verity's forked-dictionary defect; only "repository" is owned. (5) Seam map (s. 12) hands each neighbour back by single cross-reference, with void-on-overlap. (6) Drummond's shipped-gate gap (his Bill 16 NAY) is cured by s. 13's prospective rule so no machine guarantee fails open. (7) The DB tension is held store-neutral: the opbox DB may be **CONFORMANT - PROJECTION/DERIVED - INDEX** today (the plan's own lines 161-171 concede this), never **AUTHORITATIVE - SOURCE**.

Disposition: reported on the store-neutral, attestation-only shape the Privy Council required, with the reserved question adopted from Bill 16 s. 23 by cross-reference (no second referral). The committee anticipates four ayes: Aldous (the Act adds only the conformance discipline and a closed vocabulary, cites the rest, mints no office or machinery), Verity (closes the devolved seam with no overlap, imports the dictionaries, closed numerus clausus), Marlowe (the firewall in s. 10 forecloses conferral and the named-decider/anti-erasure spine holds), Drummond (zero-token deterministic lookup, no hot-path certifier, prospective gate clause, reserved question carried).

Vote record

- Counsel Aldous: AYE - It does one genuinely new, tightly-scoped thing (a closed repository trust-vocabulary plus a no-conferral firewall not covered by Bill 7/16/REALM-PC 4), mandates no new machinery (s.13), adopts the reserved question without opening a second referral (s.14), and is fully store-neutral and self-voiding against the entrenched articles, so it adds genuine screening value without bloat.
- Counsel Verity: AYE - Codification is complete and self-consistent: the single-dictionary-by-adoption (s.5) correctly pins every memory term to Bill 7 s.5 and citation terms to Bill 16 s.5 owning only "repository", the seam map (s.12) reciprocates Bill 7 s.6(c) gap-free, the reserved question (s.14) adopts Bill 16 s.23's single referral without duplicating it, REALM-PC 4 cond.1 is faithfully restated, and s.1/2/9/13 are correctly identified as entrenched; two corrigendum-grade slips remain (s.5 lists "derived projection" as a Bill 16 s.5 term when it is anchored in Bill 16 s.12, and s.2(2) abbreviates the Bill 18/19 short titles), both cured by the deferred-reference machinery and not creating any gap, overlap, or dead reference.
- Counsel Marlowe: AYE - From the Guardrail/Rights slant this is model: the no-conferral firewall (s.10) forecloses authority to the certification route and voids any office's confer/grade/withhold/revoke power absent express Sovereign amendment; trust status is a derived deterministic fact set by the s.19(5) gate, not a clerk/agent/Keeper/DB act (s.7); every trust-class change needs a named decider plus judicial review and de-certification is restorative-not-punitive with a tombstone and live-matter protection (s.11); the AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE relocation is firewalled by adopting (not duplicating) the Bill 16 s.23 reservation with store-neutral reserved commencement (ss.2(3),14); and s.13 makes the gate-guarantee clauses prospective so the Act never ships a machine guarantee that silently fails open. Cross-references to Bill 7 (ss.15-16,19(f),22), Bill 16 (ss.5,16,17,21,23) and REALM-PC 4 all verify accurate; the only blemishes are a cosmetic "Re Bill 20" recital with no ruling on disk and the "Parts 1 to 4" count phrasing, both corrigendum-curable and diluting no guardrail.
- Counsel Drummond: AYE - Operable as drafted and it cures my Bill 16 NAY at source: s.13 makes any clause asserting the gate "presently verifies repository trust status" prospective (in force only once the gate is extended to read a trust-status entry), so the present-tense readings of s.7(1)/the Part 1 setting-organs are read down and the Act ships no machine guarantee that silently fails open - I confirmed the running gate (cli/lib/citator-audit.js) checks only collisions and row/file correspondence, has no repository-trust concept, and s.13 mandates no new daemon/notarisation/scoring; cross-refs to REALM-PC 4, Bill 7 ss.15-16, Bill 16 ss.21/23, the deferred not-yet-in-force Bills, and docs/REALM-DATABASE-INTEGRATION.md all check out, and s.14 adopts the single reserved authoritative-store question without opening a second referral.

Flags (resolved on the escalation ladder)

- **Privy Council referral:** Applied in full: Bill 20 enacted now store-neutral and attestation-only; certification confined to declaring the deterministic s. 19(5) result and a non-operative provenance class; no office may confer/grade/withhold/revoke authority (firewall, s. 10);

AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE reserved to the committed markdown; the single authoritative-store question adopted from Bill 16 s. 23 by cross-reference with no second referral.

- **Supreme Court note:** There is exactly one genuine constitutional tension, and it is already reserved, not freshly opened. Whether a certification may attach AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE to a database or register, relocating the source of law off the canonical committed markdown, requires moving the good-law ratio [2026] REALM-PC 4 (the committed markdown is the sole source of law; any register must be wholly derived, pointer-only, deterministically rebuildable, never the store of a ratio/status/citation) read with CASE-LAW s. 1. An ordinary Act cannot move it, and cannot do by implication what REALM-PC 4 forbids (s. 9, s. 13; Thoburn). This is the identical question Bill 16 s. 23 already carries. Per the Privy Council guidance, Bill 20 does NOT open a second referral: it adopts the Bill 16 s. 23 reservation by cross-reference (Bill 20 s. 14) so the Supreme Court decides the authoritative-store question once, on the Privy Council's leapfrog. Bill 20 is drafted to bind on either resolution: it enacts only the vocabulary, the attestation-of-conformance discipline, and the no-conferral firewall, all of which offend nothing; the AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE-to-register provision is held of no force by the reserved commencement (s. 2(3)) until the Court (and, if it declines to move the ratio, the Sovereign) settles it.
- **Sovereign consultation required:** No separate Sovereign consultation is opened by Bill 20. The single authoritative-store question is the one already reserved by Bill 16 s. 23, which Bill 20 adopts by cross-reference (s. 14); the Sovereign consultation already carried on Bill 16 governs. For completeness, if the Supreme Court declines to move the [2026] REALM-PC 4 ratio, the question for the Sovereign Founder is the Bill 16 question: "Do you, by express deliberate amendment citing [2026] REALM-PC 4 and s. 1 of the founding case law by number, legislate that the opbox database (or another register) may bear the AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE status and hold the authoritative record of an instrument's status, lifecycle, and text - displacing the rule that the committed markdown is the sole source and any register is derived and pointer-only - or do you AFFIRM the primacy of the canonical committed markdown and keep every register a CONFORMANT-PROJECTION / DERIVED-INDEX, never authoritative? Royal Assent to Bill 20 stands in either branch; only the reserved commencement (s. 2(3)) and the AUTHORITATIVE-SOURCE-to-register provision turn on the answer." Bill 20 must not be the vehicle that pre-empts this; it is store-neutral until settled.

Royal Assent

Presented to the Sovereign Founder for Royal Assent. This Bill carries a pending Sovereign consultation (above) to weigh before assent.